# ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI)

The Board of Education recognizes the transformative potential of artificial intelligence (AI) to redefine and elevate learning opportunities for students and staff within the Mainland Regional High School District. AI offers innovative ways to foster creativity, enhance critical thinking, personalize instruction, and prepare students for future academic, professional, and societal challenges in a technology-driven world.

This policy establishes clear guidelines to ensure the ethical and effective use of generative AI in the district. It aims to:

- Promote responsible and intentional use of AI tools that align with the district's educational mission and values.
- Safeguard academic integrity by defining acceptable and unacceptable practices when using AI.
- Equip students and staff with the knowledge and skills to critically evaluate and apply AI-generated content.
- Foster an environment where AI is used as a support tool to enhance understanding, collaboration, and mastery of educational objectives, rather than a substitute for genuine effort and engagement.
- Address potential risks associated with AI, including bias, misinformation, overreliance, and ethical considerations regarding privacy and attribution.
- Ensure equitable access to AI tools and resources while addressing digital equity issues.

By embracing the potential of AI while addressing its challenges, this policy ensures that its use contributes positively to the district's commitment to academic excellence, innovation, and ethical responsibility.

## Definitions

1. AI: Refers to artificial intelligence technologies, including generative AI that produces new content such as text, images, videos, or music.
2. AI Tools: Software applications and platforms utilizing AI to perform tasks and solve problems that mimic human intelligence.

## Scope

This policy applies to all students, staff, and faculty within the Mainland Regional High School District and governs all applications of AI tools in academic, professional, and extracurricular settings. The scope includes, but is not limited to:

1. Classroom instruction, assignments, and assessments.
2. Administrative functions and decision-making processes.
3. Professional development activities for staff and educators.
4. Research and extracurricular activities where AI tools are employed.
5. AI-related projects integrated into the curriculum.

The policy covers all generative AI tools and technologies that produce content, provide solutions, or facilitate tasks. It applies to both district-provided and personally utilized AI tools, ensuring consistency in ethical standards and practices across all uses.

## Policy Statement

This policy outlines the responsible use of artificial intelligence (AI) in educational settings to ensure that it enhances learning outcomes while maintaining ethical standards. Artificial intelligence can significantly enhance education by boosting creativity, engagement, and personalized learning. When used responsibly, AI aids educational goals and professional practice. The district ensures all AI applications:

- Align with the district's core values and educational goals.
- Support, rather than replace, student learning and critical thinking.

- Promote academic integrity, creativity, and responsible digital citizenship.
- Encourage critical evaluation of AI-generated content to address potential biases and inaccuracies.
- Provide equitable access and support for all students, addressing disparities in technology use.

AI use in the district must reflect a balanced approach where students and staff leverage the technology to support human effort, maintain ethical standards, and enhance the overall learning process. Proper oversight, guidance, and instruction will ensure that AI tools are used appropriately and effectively within the district's educational framework.

**HIB/Code of Conduct Violations Due to the Misuse of Artificial Intelligence**

The creation, distribution, or promotion of harmful content using Artificial Intelligence (AI), such as deepfakes, false information, or offensive material, is strictly prohibited. This includes AI impersonation, generating inappropriate content, or cyberbullying activities. Violations of this policy will result in disciplinary action in accordance with the District's Harassment, Intimidation, and Bullying (HIB) policy (5131.1) and the Code of Student Conduct (5131) including possible police notification and/or charges.

**Adopted:** 02/24/2025, 3/10/2025

**References**


1. AI4K12 Initiative. (n.d.). *Five Big Ideas of AI*. Retrieved from https://ai4k12.org/
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3. ISTE. (2023). *AI Explorations and Their Practical Use in Schools*. Retrieved from https://www.iste.org/learn/AI-Explorations
4. ISTE. (2023). *Bringing AI to School: Tips for School Leaders*. Retrieved from https://www.iste.org/
5. Jisc. (2024). *Generative AI - A Primer*. Retrieved from https://nationalcentreforai.jiscinvolve.org/
6. Miller, M. (2023). *AI for Educators: Learning Strategies, Teacher Resources, and Classroom Best Practices*. Indianapolis: Ditch That Textbook.
7. Mollick, E. (2023). *Co-Intelligence: Living and Working with AI*. New York: Penguin Press.
8. U.S. Department of Education, Office of Educational Technology. (2023). *Artificial Intelligence and the Future of Teaching and Learning: Insights and Recommendations*. Retrieved from https://tech.ed.gov
9. ASCD. (2025). *AI in Schools*, Educational Leadership, 82(5). Alexandria, VA: ASCD.


**Legal References**

1. New Jersey Statutes Annotated **N.J.S.A. 18A:36-35** (Student Information Privacy).
2. New Jersey Administrative Code **N.J.A.C. 6A:8-3.1** (Curriculum and Instruction Standards).
3. New Jersey Administrative Code **N.J.A.C. 6A:16-7.1** (Student Conduct and Discipline).